



◀ **Manufacturer:** Tenma
Model: 21-10115 UK soldering station
Highlights: ESD safe, 150°C to 450°C range, computerised temperature calibration, heating element malfunction alert
Price: ₹ 6202 (as listed on element14.com)

Manufacturer: Hakko
Model: 150W, FX-838 soldering station
Highlights: 200°C-500°C range, 20 different tip shapes, auto-sleep function, auto-power shut-off, heavy-duty station for industrial applications
Price: ₹ 75,950 (as listed on element14.com)



◀ **Manufacturer:** Soldron
Model: 878D multi-function ESD-protected hot air and iron digital rework station
Highlights: ESD safe, MCU based smart circuit design, sleep function to save energy
Price: ₹ 5900 (as listed on company website)

Manufacturer: Weller
Model: WES51D soldering station
Highlights: Wireless temperature lockout, ESD safe, new heater and sensor design, auto-shut-off feature, MCU-controlled station with LED display
Price: ₹ 16,075 (as listed on element14.com)



◀ **Manufacturer:** Pluto
Model: 555 MC soldering station
Highlights: Alumina ceramic heater, auto-sleep function, 50°C to 450°C/180°C to 480°C temperature range, used for general/PV module soldering and high mass components
Price: ₹ 4500 (as listed on snapdeal.com)

oldering stations are mostly used for demanding reworks on PCB boards and are comparatively less expensive.

Rao says, "Hot-air soldering stations are optimum for professionals and hobbyists because these can

be used for preheating components before removing or can be used to reflow SMT components such as dual inline packaging (DIP), small outline integrated circuits (SOICs), quad flat packages (QFPs) and other ICs."

Some well-known brands in India

- Ersa
- Hakko
- JBC tools
- Metcal
- OK International
- Pace
- Pluto
- Soldron
- Weller

Pricing

Pricing in the recent past has been going down making these more competitive. Generally, pricing may vary from US\$ 50 to US\$ 2000, depending upon features and usability. Soldering station prices range from ₹ 4500 to ₹ 25,000. Soldering and desoldering stations typically cost anywhere from ₹ 14,500 to ₹ 135,000.

"The new-age soldering station offers a digital display, digital calibration and password lock functions at a very competitive price. Wattage of the station, precision in temperature control, display of the system and reliability in after-sales support are some important parameters to be considered."



—Sumeet Jain, director, Sumitron

He adds, "Infrared (IR) soldering stations are the most progressive solution in soldering of complex elements. IR light helps prevent mechanical damage and overheating of components due to concentration of the radiation beam of the IR spectrum at focal point."

Interesting features and their benefits

Soldering and desoldering stations are a must have for all electronics professionals. Nowadays, all stations are electrostatic discharge (ESD) safe, Restriction of Hazardous Substances (RoHS) compliant and digital in nature, informs Sumeet Jain, director, Sumitron. He says, "The new-age soldering station offers digital display, digital calibration and password